

AutoLancer

AI-Powered Freelance Pipeline Agent

Complete Build Plan & Roadmap

Global AI Hackathon with Qwen Cloud • Track 4: Autopilot Agent

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Deadline: 33 days from June 6, 2026

Tech Stack

Layer	Technology
AI / LLM	Qwen Cloud (Qwen3.6-Plus) on Alibaba Cloud
Orchestration	n8n (self-hosted or cloud)
Lead Form	HTML/CSS/JS on Netlify
Bot Intake	Telegram Bot API + Qwen conversational AI
CRM / Database	Airtable
Email	Gmail API via n8n
Payments	Flutterwave
Alerts / Control	Telegram Bot (owner alerts)
Logging	Google Sheets (backup)
Deployment	Alibaba Cloud + Netlify

PHASE 1

Lead Intake Layer

Step 1.1 [DONE]

HTML Lead Form

Professional 8-field intake form hosted on Netlify. Webhooks to n8n on submit.

- Build responsive HTML form with 8 fields (name, email, project type, budget, timeline, source, description, existing tools)
- Style with dark theme, DM Sans + Fraunces typography
- Add form validation, loading spinner, success/error states
- POST JSON payload to n8n webhook URL on submit
- Deploy to Netlify via GitHub repo (autolancer)
- Test webhook delivery end-to-end

Tools: HTML, CSS, JS, Netlify, GitHub

Step 1.2 [PENDING]

Telegram Bot Intake

Conversational bot that asks qualifying questions via natural chat. Qwen extracts structured lead data from free-text responses.

- Create Telegram bot via BotFather, get API token
- Build n8n workflow: Telegram Trigger node receives messages
- Design conversation flow: greeting → ask project type → budget → timeline → description
- Use Qwen API to manage conversation state and extract structured data
- When all fields collected, format into same JSON schema as web form
- POST normalized lead to the shared scoring pipeline
- Add intake_channel: "telegram_bot" tag to distinguish from form leads

Tools: Telegram Bot API, n8n, Qwen Cloud API

Step 1.3 [PENDING]

Data Normalizer

Ensures both intake channels produce identical structured lead profiles for the scoring engine.

- Create n8n Function node that validates required fields
- Map Telegram bot free-text answers to dropdown-equivalent values

- Add timestamp, unique lead ID, and channel tag

- Output unified JSON: {lead_id, full_name, email, project_type, budget_range, timeline, source, description, existing_tools, intake_channel, submitted_at}

Tools: n8n Function node

PHASE 2

AI Scoring & Decision Engine

Step 2.1 [PENDING]

Qwen AI Lead Scoring

Qwen analyzes each lead and assigns a score from 1-100 based on budget, timeline, project fit, complexity, and specificity.

- Set up Qwen Cloud API access (Alibaba Cloud Model Studio account)
- Build n8n HTTP Request node calling Qwen3.6-Plus API
- Craft scoring prompt: input = lead JSON, output = {score: 0-100, reasoning: "...", category: "high|medium|low"}
- Score weights: budget (25%), timeline feasibility (20%), project fit (25%), description specificity (20%), referral source (10%)
- Parse Qwen JSON response in n8n
- Log score + reasoning to Google Sheets for audit trail

Tools: Qwen Cloud API (Qwen3.6-Plus), n8n HTTP Request, Google Sheets

Step 2.2 [PENDING]

Decision Gate (IF/Switch)

Routes leads down different paths based on AI score.

- n8n Switch node: score ≥ 70 → HIGH path, 40-69 → MEDIUM path, < 40 → LOW path
- HIGH: trigger proposal generation (Step 3.1)
- MEDIUM: trigger nurture email sequence (Step 3.3)
- LOW: trigger polite decline email (Step 3.4)
- All paths: send Telegram alert to owner with lead summary + score

Tools: n8n Switch node, Telegram Bot

PHASE 3

Proposal & Communication

Step 3.1 [PENDING]

Qwen Proposal Generator

Auto-generates a custom project proposal based on lead data and score analysis.

- Build Qwen prompt: input = lead data + score reasoning, output = proposal with scope, deliverables, timeline, pricing
- Include your service catalog context in the system prompt (automation, web dev, chatbot, integration)
- Generate pricing based on budget range + estimated complexity
- Format proposal as clean HTML email body
- Store generated proposal in Airtable for record keeping

Tools: Qwen Cloud API, n8n, Airtable

Step 3.2 [PENDING]

Human-in-the-Loop Approval

Owner receives proposal preview on Telegram and approves, edits, or rejects before it reaches the client.

- Send proposal summary to owner via Telegram with inline keyboard buttons: Approve / Edit / Reject
- Build n8n Wait node that pauses workflow until Telegram callback received
- If Approve: proceed to email delivery
- If Edit: owner sends revised text, Qwen reformats, re-sends for approval
- If Reject: send polite "not a fit" email to client instead
- Timeout: if no response in 12 hours, send Telegram reminder

Tools: Telegram Bot (inline keyboard), n8n Wait node

Step 3.3 [PENDING]

Email Delivery + Follow-up Sequence

Sends the approved proposal via Gmail and follows up if no response.

- Send proposal email via Gmail node (HTML formatted)
- Day 3: if no reply, send friendly follow-up reminder

- Day 7: final nudge with a soft deadline ("offer valid until...")

- Track email status in Airtable (sent, followed_up, responded, expired)

- If client replies, trigger Telegram alert to owner

Tools: Gmail (n8n node), n8n Wait/Schedule nodes, Airtable

Step 3.4 [PENDING]

Decline & Nurture Paths

Handles medium and low-scoring leads gracefully.

- LOW leads: send polite decline email with helpful resource links

- MEDIUM leads: send introductory email, add to nurture list in Airtable

- MEDIUM leads: schedule bi-weekly check-in email sequence

- Both paths: log outcome in Google Sheets

Tools: Gmail, Airtable, n8n Schedule node

PHASE 4

Client Onboarding & Payment

Step 4.1 [PENDING]

Client Onboarding Flow

When a client accepts the proposal, automatically set up their project infrastructure.

- Detect acceptance (client replies "yes" / clicks accept link in email)
- Create new Airtable record in Projects table: client name, project scope, timeline, status, payment status
- Send welcome email with project overview, timeline, and next steps
- Create dedicated Telegram group or channel for project updates (optional)
- Notify owner via Telegram: "New client onboarded: [name] - [project type]"

Tools: Airtable, Gmail, Telegram Bot, n8n

Step 4.2 [PENDING]

Invoice Generation & Payment

Auto-generate invoice and send Flutterwave payment link.

- Generate invoice details from Airtable project record (scope, pricing)
- Create Flutterwave payment link via API (HTTP Request node)
- Send invoice email with embedded payment link
- Set up Flutterwave webhook to n8n: listen for payment confirmation
- On payment received: update Airtable status to "paid", notify owner via Telegram
- If unpaid after 3 days: send payment reminder email

Tools: Flutterwave API, Gmail, Airtable, Telegram, n8n

Step 4.3 [PENDING]

Project Kickoff Notification

Final step — both parties get confirmation that the project is officially underway.

- Send kickoff email to client: project start date, communication channels, what to expect
- Send Telegram notification to owner with full project brief
- Update Airtable project status to "active"
- Log complete pipeline journey in Google Sheets (lead → score → proposal → payment → kickoff)

Tools: Gmail, Telegram, Airtable, Google Sheets

PHASE 5

Hackathon Submission

Step 5.1 [PENDING]

Demo Video (3 minutes)

Record a compelling walkthrough showing the full pipeline in action.

- Script the demo: problem statement → architecture → live walkthrough → results
- Show a real lead submitting via web form
- Show a real lead chatting with the Telegram bot
- Show Qwen scoring both leads in real-time
- Show proposal generation and Telegram approval flow
- Show email delivery and Flutterwave payment
- End with impact: "built for freelancers, powered by Qwen"

Tools: Screen recorder, video editor

Step 5.2 [PENDING]

Devpost Submission

Fill out all 5 steps of the hackathon submission form.

- Project name: AutoLancer
- Elevator pitch: written and ready
- Full description: problem, solution, architecture, Qwen integration, impact
- Link GitHub repo (public, open-source)
- Upload architecture diagram
- Embed demo video
- Tag Track 4: Autopilot Agent
- List Alibaba Cloud products used (Qwen Cloud, Model Studio)

Tools: Devpost, GitHub, YouTube/Loom

Step 5.3 [PENDING]

Alibaba Cloud Proof of Use

Ensure the project meets the Alibaba Cloud deployment requirement.

- Screenshot of Qwen Cloud API usage dashboard

- Screenshot of Model Studio account showing API calls
- Document all Qwen API endpoints used in the project
- Include Alibaba Cloud branding in README and submission

Tools: Alibaba Cloud Console, screenshots

Recommended Build Order

Follow this sequence for the most efficient build. Each step builds on the previous one.

#	Task	Est. Time	Status
1	HTML Lead Form (Step 1.1)	1 day	DONE ✓
2	n8n Webhook + Data Normalizer (Step 1.3)	1 day	
3	Qwen Cloud API Setup + Lead Scoring (Step 2.1)	2 days	
4	Decision Gate + Telegram Alerts (Step 2.2)	1 day	
5	Qwen Proposal Generator (Step 3.1)	2 days	
6	Human-in-the-Loop Telegram Approval (Step 3.2)	2 days	
7	Gmail Delivery + Follow-up Sequence (Step 3.3-3.4)	2 days	
8	Client Onboarding → Airtable (Step 4.1)	1 day	
9	Flutterwave Invoice + Payment (Step 4.2-4.3)	2 days	
10	Telegram Bot Intake (Step 1.2)	3 days	
11	End-to-End Testing + Bug Fixes	3 days	
12	Demo Video + Devpost Submission (Step 5.1-5.3)	3 days	
	TOTAL ESTIMATED	~23 days	

10 days of buffer before the deadline. Use it for polish, edge cases, and making the demo video shine.